IA

Inventory Analyzer

READ-ONLY FOLDER AND FILE INVENTORY

FAQ AND TROUBLESHOOTING

FAQ and Troubleshooting

Answers to common questions and fixes for common problems

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Audience Users, administrators and support teams

Document control

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1.0	24-Oct-2026	Yasin Jariwala	First release: read-only folder scan, dashboard, inventory, storage analysis, optional duplicates, Excel and CSV exports, scan history
1.1	24-Oct-2026	Yasin Jariwala	Folder Explorer, Where your files are, Show in folder tree, Folder Tree sheet
1.2	24-Oct-2026	Yasin Jariwala	Reopen saved scans and download their reports; seven numbered guides inside the app

Related documents

ID	Document
IA-UG-01	User Guide
IA-IG-02	Installation and Administration Guide
IA-QS-03	Quick Start
IA-TD-05	Technical Design
IA-UAT-06	UAT Test Cases
IA-RN-07	Release Notes v1.2

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1 Frequently asked questions

1.1 General

Does the app ever change, move or delete my files?

No. Folders are opened with read-only permission, and the app contains no code that writes to, moves, renames or deletes files. You can scan the same folder as often as you like.

Is anything uploaded? Where do my files go?

Nowhere. The scan runs inside your browser on your PC. No file, name or result is sent over the network, and there is no analytics or tracking. The "upload" in **Upload a folder...** is only the browser's name for the permission dialog; nothing is uploaded.

Do I need to install anything or be an administrator?

No. The app is a single web page. On Windows, double-click `Start Inventory Analyzer.bat`; it needs no administrator rights.

Which browser should I use?

Microsoft Edge or Google Chrome. They support every feature, including empty-folder detection. Firefox and Safari can scan with **Upload a folder...** but cannot see empty folders.

Can it scan a network drive, OneDrive or SharePoint folder?

It can scan any folder that appears in the folder picker with a drive letter or path, including mapped network drives and synced OneDrive or SharePoint folders. Files that are "online only" may report their full size without being downloaded, or fail to read and appear in Scan Errors. It cannot connect to a SharePoint site or cloud storage directly.

Can it scan a whole drive such as C:\?

Browsers do not allow picking a whole system drive or system folders such as `C:\Windows`. Pick a folder instead. Very large trees (several hundred thousand files) may exhaust the browser's memory; scan them in parts.

Why are there no full paths like C:\Users...?

Browsers deliberately hide where the chosen folder is on disk. Paths start at the folder you chose, for example `Shared Drive/Finance/2024/invoice_001.pdf`.

Why are there no "created" or "last accessed" dates, or hidden files?

Browsers only expose a file's last-modified date. They also do not reveal the Windows or macOS "hidden" attribute. The app does not guess these. Names starting with "." can be included or left out with **Include dot-prefixed items**.

1.2 Counts and sizes

What is the difference between "files here" and "in total"?

"Files here" (direct) counts files sitting directly in a folder. "In total" (recursive) also counts every file in all its subfolders, at any depth. Each file is counted once in its own folder's "here" count and once in the "in total" count of every folder above it.

Why does the size differ from what Windows Explorer shows?

The app shows **logical size**: the size of the files' contents. Windows Explorer's "Size on disk" also includes unused space in disk clusters, compression and cloud placeholders. Compare against Explorer's "Size", not "Size on disk". Also check that dot-prefixed items were included and that there were no Scan Errors.

Why does the file count differ from Windows Explorer?

Check three things: whether **Include dot-prefixed items** was on (Explorer also counts these), whether Scan Errors lists folders that could not be opened (their files are not counted), and whether Explorer is showing hidden and system files. Folders that could not be opened are marked incomplete.

Why is a folder "unknown" and not "empty"?

Because the app could not open it, so it does not know what is inside. Reporting it as empty would be a guess. It appears in Scan Errors with the reason.

How are duplicates found? Are files with the same name duplicates?

No: the name does not matter. Files are grouped by size; files that share a size are read and fingerprinted with SHA-256; only files with identical fingerprints are duplicates. Duplicate detection is off by default because reading contents takes time.

The app found duplicates. Will it remove them?

No. It never deletes anything. Use the Duplicate Files screen or the Duplicate Files sheet to decide what to keep, then tidy up in Windows Explorer.

1.3 Reports and history

Which report should I send to someone?

The Excel workbook (**Excel (.xlsx)**). It has an Executive Summary and every report on its own sheet. The **Folder Tree** sheet answers "which folder has how many files, and where is each file".

What if the folder has more than a million files?

Excel sheets hold at most 1,048,576 rows. Larger reports continue on numbered sheets, for example "File Inventory (2)". Nothing is cut off. CSV files have no row limit.

Can I get the reports of an earlier scan again?

Yes, from **Scan History**: **Open** shows every screen again; **Excel** and **CSVs** download the reports straight away. Full results are kept for the newest 20 scans.

Where is the scan history stored? Can colleagues see it?

In your browser's storage on your PC only. Nobody else can see it. The desktop launcher and the shared link keep separate histories, and a private window keeps none.

Can I compare two scans to see what changed?

Not yet. Scan comparison is on the roadmap (Release Notes, IA-RN-07).

2 Troubleshooting

2.1 Opening the app

Problem	Likely cause	What to do
Double-clicking the .bat file does nothing, or says it could not find the HTML file	The HTML file is not in the same folder as the .bat file	Keep `Start Inventory Analyzer.bat` and `Inventory Analyzer.html` together
"Windows protected your PC"	SmartScreen warning for a downloaded .bat file	Click **More info > Run anyway**, or open the HTML file directly in Edge
The .bat file was blocked by email	Mail filters block .bat attachments	Send only the HTML file, or share the folder on a drive
The shared link shows "Sign in to view this page"	The link has not been shared	The owner opens it on claude.ai and chooses **Share > Anyone with the link**
The page is blank in an old browser	Browser too old	Update Edge or Chrome

2.2 Choosing a folder

Message or problem	Likely cause	What to do
Choose folder... is greyed out	Firefox, Safari, or a browser without the folder picker	Use **Upload a folder...**, or switch to Edge or Chrome
"The folder picker is blocked in this context"	Opened inside the shared link's hosting page	Use **Upload a folder...**, or the desktop launcher
The browser says it can't open the folder because it contains system files	You picked a drive or a system folder	Pick a folder inside it
Nothing happens after closing the picker	You cancelled	Click **Choose folder...** again
"The browser returned no files"	The folder is empty, holds only empty subfolders (which upload mode cannot see), or the dialog was cancelled	Check the folder; use **Choose folder...** in Edge or Chrome to see empty folders
The upload dialog takes a long time before the scan starts	The browser lists every file first in upload mode	Wait, or use **Choose folder...** in Edge or Chrome

2.3 During and after the scan

Message or problem	Likely cause	What to do
Many permission-denied errors	Protected or system folders inside the selection	Pick a narrower folder, or ask for access
not-readable on some files	Files open or locked in another program (Outlook data files, open Office documents)	Close the program and scan again

Message or problem	Likely cause	What to do
"Scanned on the main thread" message	The browser did not allow a background worker	No action needed; results are identical. The page may feel slower on big folders.
The browser becomes slow or the tab crashes	Hundreds of thousands of files held in memory	Close other tabs and scan subfolders separately
No percentage is shown	The total number of files is not known until the folder has been walked	Expected; the counters show progress
Duplicate detection is very slow	Many large files share a size and must be read	Lower the hashing size limit in Settings, or scan a smaller folder
Many files "unverified"	Files above the hashing limit, or unreadable	Raise the hashing size limit in Settings if needed
Empty Folders is empty after an upload scan	Upload mode cannot see empty folders	Scan with **Choose folder...** in Edge or Chrome

2.4 Downloads

Message or problem	Likely cause	What to do
"Save cancelled — no file was saved"	You declined the save prompt (shared link)	Click the download button again and confirm
"Export failed: ... No partial file was produced"	Usually not enough browser memory to build the workbook of a very large scan	Use **All CSVs (.zip)**, which uses less memory
Names with accents look wrong in a CSV	The CSV was opened with an old text import setting	Open it by double-clicking; the files are UTF-8 with a byte-order mark that Excel recognises
A cell starts with an apostrophe in the CSV	Protection against spreadsheet formula injection	Expected for values starting with `=`, `+`, `-` or `@`

2.5 Scan History

Message or problem	Likely cause	What to do
A scan shows **Summary only** and cannot be opened	Older than the newest 20 scans, made before v1.2, or made with **Keep full results** off	Scan the folder again
Scan History is empty after reopening the app	Private window, browsing data cleared, or a different way of opening the app (launcher vs shared link)	Use a normal window and the same way of opening; keep the Excel reports you need
"Browser storage is full, so this scan could not be stored"	The browser's storage quota for the app is used up	Delete old scans in Scan History, or free disk space
"Scan history is open in another tab with an older version of the app"	Two versions of the app are open	Close the other Inventory Analyzer tabs and try again

Message or problem	Likely cause	What to do
"IndexedDB is not available … scan history is disabled"	Storage blocked by browser settings or policy	Scanning and downloads still work; download the reports you need

Still stuck?

Note the scan ID (Scan History or the Executive Summary sheet), the screen, and the exact message. A screenshot of **Scan Errors** helps. Bugs and questions can be raised as issues on the GitHub repository.